Grievance Mechanism

WWF North Africa

A. Context & Objective

WWF North Africa (WWF-NA) is committed to promoting transparency, accountability, and inclusiveness across all its actions and partnerships. In this regard, the Grievance Mechanism (GRM) is an essential tool that enables stakeholders — including local communities, institutional partners, businesses, donors, beneficiaries, and the general public — to access safe and reliable channels to express complaints, concerns, or suggestions.

The objectives of the GRM are to:

- strengthen trust between WWF-NA and its stakeholders,
- encourage open dialogue and constructive participation,
- continuously improve the quality and impact of the projects and programs implemented.

By establishing this mechanism, WWF-NA demonstrates its commitment to listening, addressing, and resolving complaints or concerns appropriately, while also using each submission as an opportunity for learning and strengthening organizational practices.

B. Channels Available to Submit a Complaint

WWF North Africa (WWF-NA) provides multiple accessible and appropriate channels to identify and receive complaints:

1. **By e-mail:** grm.contact@wwfna.org
2. **By postal mail:** 3 rue El Moez, El Menzah 1, 1004 Tunis, Tunisia
3. **Via the WWF-NA online contact form**
4. **Via the grievance form** accessible through a QR code featured on WWF-NA communication materials, to be completed and submitted via the above e-mail address.
5. **Social media :**
   - Ideally, complaints should be submitted through the official channels listed above.
   - WWF-NA does not encourage the use of social media for filing complaints.
   - However, if a complaint is received via direct message or by tagging WWF-NA in a post, it will be acknowledged and redirected to the appropriate channel.

- WWF-NA will not respond publicly to complaints on social media. Instead, individuals will be invited to use the official channels to ensure the matter is addressed confidentially and appropriately, including initiating an investigation if required.

6. Complaints submitted directly to staff:

- Complaints may be raised directly with WWF-NA staff by members of the public, local communities, beneficiaries, suppliers, or partners (e.g., during an event, workshop, training, etc.).
- Staff are required to escalate general complaints to the relevant team within WWF-NA.

7. EthicsPoint System :

For all serious complaints, WWF provides the EthicsPoint platform, available to any individual (employee, partner, contractor, or member of the public) via the following link: **Ethics Reporting Hotline**

This system may be used to report, among others:

- WWF internal issues: fraud, corruption, discrimination, data breaches, workplace conduct, health and safety concerns.
- Community-related issues: for example, concerns regarding WWF projects. (Additional information available in WWF's Environmental and Social Safeguards Framework at wwf.panda.org).
- Human rights issues: any serious allegations of abuse involving WWF employees or partners.

The EthicsPoint system is secure and confidential and allows reports to be submitted anonymously or with identification, in any language.

C. Grievance Mechanism (GRM) Process

Step 1 – Reception of the complaint

- Complaints may be submitted through multiple channels: e-mail, online form, QR code, postal mail, phone, social media, or in person during activities.
- Complaints can be submitted anonymously.

Step 2 – Registration and acknowledgement

- Each complaint is recorded in the GRM register with a unique reference number.

- An acknowledgement of receipt is sent to the complainant (if contact details are provided) within a maximum of 15 working days.

Step 3 – Initial screening

- The GRM focal point reviews the complaint to determine:
    - its admissibility,
    - its level of urgency,
    - whether it relates to environmental, social, governance, or human rights issues.
- If the complaint does not fall within the scope of the GRM, the complainant is redirected to the appropriate channel.

Step 4 – Assessment and investigation

- A designated team conducts the investigation, gathering facts, consulting stakeholders, and ensuring confidentiality.
- The complaint file is shared with the Senior Management Team (SMT) for follow-up.

Step 5 – Resolution and response

- A corrective action plan or a mediation process is proposed.
- The complainant is informed of the findings and proposed measures within 45 working days (or longer if the case requires extended investigation).

Step 6 – Follow-up and closure

- The implementation of the agreed solution is monitored and documented.
- Once resolved, the case is officially closed and archived in the GRM register.
- Lessons learned are shared internally to improve practices.

D. WWF-NA Commitment

All complaints are handled with seriousness, respect, and confidentiality. Each submission is considered an opportunity to strengthen transparency, accountability, and integrity across WWF-NA's work.